

STAGE ONE • SELF-AWARENESS & CAREER CLARITY

FIRSTS

GROUP VERSIONS OF KEY EXERCISES

Live, group-adapted versions of the FIRSTS that benefit most from interaction

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Group Versions of Key Exercises

Stage One • Self-Awareness & Career Clarity

PURPOSE

The Templates workbook is written for solo reflection — each worksheet assumes one person, working alone, filling in their own answers. That's the right default for most of Stage One's eighteen FIRSTS. But a handful genuinely come alive with a live, social version: hearing your own value named back to you by a partner, saying your brand narrative out loud instead of just writing it, getting an outside perspective on your own blind spots.

This document adapts seven FIRSTS across Stage One into pair, small-group, or role-play formats. These are additions, not replacements — in every case, participants complete their own individual worksheet first, then this group version deepens or stress-tests what they came up with. None of these should replace the solo reflection; the group activity works because there's already a real, individual answer to build from.

Each entry includes a suggested format, the extra time it adds beyond the solo worksheet, numbered steps you can read almost verbatim to a group, and a short note on why the live version specifically adds value here.

The Seven Adapted Exercises

FIRST 01

Core Values Audit — Paired Interview

TIME: +10 min beyond solo work

1. After individual reflection, pair participants up.
2. Partner A interviews Partner B using just one question: “Tell me about a time you had to choose between two good options — what did you actually pick, and why?” Partner A listens for the value underneath the answer, without naming it yet.
3. Partner A then guesses: “It sounds like ___ might be one of your core values — does that land?” Partner B confirms or refines.
4. Swap roles.

FACILITATOR NOTE

This works because values are often easier for an outside listener to name from a real story than for the person to name abstractly on their own. It's a genuinely useful gut-check on the solo worksheet answers.

FIRST 04

Personal Brand Narrative — Practice Circle

TIME: +15 min beyond solo drafting

1. Groups of 3-4. Each person delivers their brand narrative out loud, from memory if possible (not read off the page).
2. After each delivery, the group gives exactly one piece of feedback each: one thing that landed clearly, one word or phrase that felt vague or generic.
3. Speaker revises one sentence on the spot based on the feedback, then moves to the next person.

FACILITATOR NOTE

Saying it out loud reveals awkward phrasing that looks fine on paper. Keep feedback to the two-question format above — open-ended “any thoughts?” feedback tends to be too vague to be useful here.

FIRST 06

Weakness Awareness — Opt-In Small Circle

TIME: +10 min beyond solo work

1. Explicitly frame this as fully optional before starting.
2. For those who opt in: groups of 3. Each person shares just their thirty-day action (not the weakness itself, if they'd rather keep that private) — e.g., “I'm going to practice cold-calling three people a week.”
3. Group members can offer one resource or contact if they genuinely have one relevant; otherwise, just a supportive acknowledgment.

FACILITATOR NOTE

Never require this share. The action-only framing (rather than naming the weakness itself) makes it lower-stakes while still creating real peer accountability.

FIRST 07

Passion Alignment — Cross-Pollination Groups

TIME: +15 min beyond solo mapping

1. Groups of 4, ideally with varied target industries.
2. Each person shares their top two passions from their mapping table (not the career links yet).
3. The rest of the group brainstorms career links they wouldn't have thought of themselves, for 90 seconds per person.
4. Original person adds any genuinely new ideas to their table.

FACILITATOR NOTE

Outside perspective often surfaces career paths the person hadn't considered simply because they're too close to their own passions to see them as marketable skills.

FIRST 09

Career Path — Research Jigsaw

TIME: Replaces solo LinkedIn scan; same total time

1. Groups of 3-4, each targeting a similar broad field.
2. Assign each person a different seniority level to research on LinkedIn (entry, mid, senior) rather than having everyone do all three alone.
3. Each person traces 3 real professionals at their assigned level and notes common entry points.
4. Group reconvenes and pools findings into one shared career-path map covering all three levels.

FACILITATOR NOTE

This produces a richer, faster result than everyone doing the full scan solo, and it's a natural way to build real peer connections around a shared target field.

FIRST 12

Career SWOT Analysis — Blind Spot Swap

TIME: +10 min beyond solo drafting

1. Pairs. Each person shares only their Strengths and Opportunities paragraphs (not Weaknesses/Threats) with their partner.
2. Partner listens, then offers one Weakness or Threat they'd genuinely add based on what they just heard — something the person may be blind to.
3. Each person decides whether to incorporate the outside perspective into their own analysis.

FACILITATOR NOTE

People are often more comfortable hearing a blind spot named by a peer than confronting it alone, and outside perspective genuinely catches things self-assessment alone misses.

FIRST 14

Personality Assessment — *Guess-the-Type*

TIME: +10 min beyond solo reflection

1. Before revealing results, small groups try to guess each other's four-letter type (or equivalent) based only on how people have behaved in the session so far.
2. Each person then reveals their actual result and shares whether the group's guess was close.
3. Quick discussion: what specifically gave it away, or what was surprising about being wrong?

FACILITATOR NOTE

This is genuinely fun and also reinforces the core lesson: personality shows up in observable behavior, not just self-report — useful groundwork for FIRST 22 (Professional Reputation Audit) much later in the program.